E R I C D E C A S P E R

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EDUCATION

California Polytechnic State University | San Luis Obispo, CA **2022 - Current**
Bachelor of Science in **Mechanical Engineering** Expected Graduation: December 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS:

- SolidWorks
- Onshape
- Autodesk Fusion 360
- DFM/GD&T
- FEA (ANSYS)
- 3D Printing (FDM/SLA/SLS)
- Python
- Java
- MATLAB

WORK EXPERIENCE:

Western Magnetics Company | South San Francisco, CA **June 2026 - August 2026**
Mechanical Engineering Intern

- Designed and built the end-of-line test stand that now grades every motor coming off the production line, screening electrical imbalance, vibration, and drag in a 45-second cycle — over 4,400 cycles by August.
- Created an in-line testing process for magnet bond strength that caught an under cured batch before it shipped, and qualified an adhesive 2–3x stronger, cutting adhesion failures from >70% to near 0%.
- Owned custom wire-EDM tooling from design through fabrication and set up an outside machining partnership that turns around urgent tooling in about a week.
- Traced motor KV variation to magnet thickness and lamination tolerance stack-up, then built a measurement fixture so the team could quantify and control it.

Voliro AG | Zurich, Switzerland **July 2025 - December 2025**
Mechanical Engineering Intern

- Developed aerial spot-repair payloads with Monti Power from concept through flight-tested prototypes, proving out a find-it/fix-it workflow — inspect and repair on one platform — that Voliro now sells as a service.
- Re-architected legacy payload assemblies in SolidWorks into modular, maintainable CAD structures to support scalable product development and future payload updates and integration.
- Designed and validated a cooling solution for a next-generation drone radio, building a 40°C environmental chamber to verify sustained operation at worst-case ambient temperature.

ENGINEERING PROJECTS

Payload R&D, Voliro AG | Cal Poly SLO **January 2026 - Present**

- Leading an industry-sponsored senior project with Voliro AG: a drone-mounted robotic arm that sweeps an electromagnetic sensor across steel structures to inspect them for defects at height.
- Designed the two-link carbon fiber arm under 1 kg limit and built its onboard control system — a Teensy microcontroller running inverse kinematics to drive two servos, networked to the drone over Ethernet.
- Built and bench-tested the payload on real steel assets; currently integrating it onto a Voliro drone shipped to Cal Poly for independent flight testing.

Aerial Manipulation Machine Learning Project | Cal Poly SLO **September 2026 - Present**

- Training imitation-learning controllers (ACT, Diffusion Policy) in Isaac Lab for a drone-mounted arm, benchmarking data requirements toward a learned controller for our senior project payload.

LEADERSHIP AND INVOLVEMENT

Homestead High School Robotics, FRC Team 670 | Cupertino, CA **August 2021 - June 2022**
Mechanical Lead

- Spearheaded the design and fabrication processes leveraging Mills, Laser Cutters, CNC routers, and 3D printers.
- Designed and integrated a custom vacuum and compressed air system into a CNC router for aluminum cutting.
- Earned recognition as the recipient of the FIRST Quality Award and 2022 Cal Games Champion.

Languages:

- English
- Swiss German (Conversational)
- French (Conversational)